# Year 2 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

**Version 3.1, October 2026.** Version 3.1 is version 1 with clearer printed instructions in maths Section B (questions 11, 13, 17, 19 and 20), after a review by the mathematics department. In question 20 the child now draws a circle (not a tick) for the half turn. Use with `Y02/Y02_Student_Booklet_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

**Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages.** Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y02_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For a child joining **Year 2** (about 6 years old). Most have finished the top year of a Chinese kindergarten (大班); some come from bilingual kindergartens, and a child joining mid-year may have started Grade 1. The visit takes **about 50 minutes** (47 minutes of tasks, plus the welcome and a short break). It is **1:1, or a pair for some tasks** (see the box below). The child writes the listening, maths and writing answers in the Year 2 student booklet, and you write the marks in the mark boxes on the child's pages. You record everything else on the child's grading sheet, Reading front sheet and Interview sheet.

## 1. At a glance

| Order | Task | Minutes | 1:1 or pair | Materials | Student booklet | These instructions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Welcome | 1 | either | | page 1 (you write the child's name) | Section 2 |
| 2 | Speaking: picture talk | 4 | always 1:1 | | page 2 | 3.1 |
| 3 | Listening: follow instructions (recording) | about 5 | 1:1 or pair | crayons: red, blue, yellow, green | page 3 | 3.2 |
| 4 | Reading: Early Reading Screen, then Graded Sentence Reading Screen | 12 | always 1:1 | shared cards, Early Reading Screen record sheets, Reading front sheet, levelled books, plain card | (separate cards) | 3.3 |
| 5 | Movement break | 2 | either | water | | Section 2 |
| 6 | Maths | 15 | 1:1 or pair | pencil, rubber, 20 counters | pages 4 to 10 | Section 4 |
| 7 | Writing | 6 | 1:1 or pair | pencil | pages 11 and 12 | 3.4 |
| 8 | Play-based interview and goodbye | 6 | always 1:1 | crayons, Interviewer guide, Interview sheet | page 13 | Section 5 |
| | **Total** | **about 51** | | | | |

The order follows the blueprint for Years 1 to 3. These instructions put all the English tasks together in Section 3, so **writing (3.4) comes after maths on the day**.

### Assessing two children together

Use a pair only when you need to (for example, twins or a busy admissions day). Each child has their own student booklet and grading sheet, and sits where they cannot see the other child's page.

- **Together:** listening, maths and writing. Give each instruction once to both children. In listening item 9, watch both children to see which part each does first.
- **Always 1:1:** picture talk, the reading screens and the interview. While one child does these, the other child draws on page 13 with a second adult (or with their parent) in the room; in the interview, talk about that drawing or let the child add to it.
- **Order for a pair:** welcome; picture talk (one child, then the other); listening; reading screens (one child, then the other); break; maths; writing; interviews. The picture talk still comes before the writing, so both children have talked about the story before they write about it.

### What to print

**For each candidate:**

- Year 2 student booklet: A4, single-sided, in colour if possible (the pictures also work in greyscale)
- the grading sheet (`Y02/Y02_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`)
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`)
- the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`)
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`)
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`), completed after the visit
- the Early Reading Screen record sheets (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`): only the sheets you expect to use

**For the room (print once, laminate the cards):**

- these instructions
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2`)
- the Sentence Reading Guide (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`)
- the Graded Sentence Reading Screen card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`)
- the Early Reading Screen cards (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`) and guide (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`)
- levelled reading books (`01_Reading_Books_and_Materials`)
- 20 counters, all the same colour and size, in a small pot
- 4 crayons (red, blue, yellow, green), 2 pencils, a rubber (per child)
- a plain card about A5 size, a small slip of paper, a watch or timer

## 2. Before you start

**The room.** Use a low table. Sit beside the child at a corner of the table, not opposite. Keep the counters and crayons out of sight until each task needs them. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door: keep the door open or have a second adult in the room. Show the child where the parent will wait.

**Pace of speech.** Year 2 students are still learning English: speak slowly and clearly, in short phrases, with a pause of about a second after each phrase. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared (do not slow down further for a child who finds it hard, and repeat an instruction only where these instructions allow it). The listening recording is paced the same way: a clear, steady voice with a pause of about a second after each phrase.

**Welcome (1 minute).** Say:

> "Hello! My name is [your name]. What's your name?" (wait) "Hello, [name]. How old are you?" (wait) "Today we are going to look at some pictures, play a listening game, read, do some maths and write. Some things are easy and some things are tricky. That's OK. Just try your best."

Write the child's name on the cover of the student booklet. Note how the child first responds (English, Chinese, gesture, silence).

### Access rules for Year 2

| | English tasks: picture talk, listening, reading, writing | Maths |
|---|---|---|
| What you may say | Only the words in the script. Do not explain words, translate, point or show what to do. You may repeat an instruction once if the child asks or clearly did not hear: tick **R** on the grading sheet. | **Read every question aloud.** Repeat it in English as often as needed and point to the picture. You may show with counters, but do not do the question for the child. |
| Chinese | Not used by you. | If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot follow the English after you have read it aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Mark the item **L** and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts. |
| Answers | English words, marks on the picture and pointing count. An answer in Chinese scores 0. | Written numbers, ticks, drawings and spoken answers in English all count. An answer in Chinese scores 0. |
| Not yet taught | | If the child or parent tells you the child has not learnt a topic ("我们还没学"), mark **NT**. It scores 0; list it on the grading sheet. |

Codes on the grading sheet: **R** instruction repeated once; **L** language support in maths; **NT** not yet taught. Extra time, a reader or extra breaks for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet. Wherever these instructions say "note it", write the note in the comment space on the grading sheet.

### Keeping the child at ease

- Praise effort, never correctness: "You are working hard!", "Thank you!", "Good listening!" Use the same warm tone after right and wrong answers. Never say "No" or "Wrong", and do not correct.
- Some children new to English say very little at first. Smile, wait and move on; never pressure the child.
- If the child is tired, take a short extra break. If the child becomes upset, stop, comfort them and let them go to the parent. Try again later if they recover; otherwise end the visit and record what was done on the grading sheet.

### Stopping rules

| Task | Stop when |
|---|---|
| Picture talk | the child has not answered three prompts in a row. Finish with an easy "What's this?" so the child ends with success. |
| Listening | three items in a row score 0. Score the rest 0. (In a pair, carry on until both children have stopped, but score each child's items after their own third 0 as 0.) |
| Reading screens | as the Early Reading Screen guide and the Sentence Reading Guide say. |
| Maths | three items in a row score 0 in Section A: go on to Section B, which starts easy again. Three in a row score 0 in Section B: stop. |
| Writing | the child says they cannot do more after one encouragement ("Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear."). |

**Movement break (about 2 minutes, after reading).** Say: "Let's have a break! Stand up. Stretch up high. Touch your toes. Jump three times. Now sit down." Do the actions with the child. It is not scored. Offer water and the toilet.

## 3. English

### 3.1 Speaking: picture talk (4 minutes, 1:1, student booklet page 2)

The story has four pictures. 1: Jun walks to school in the sunshine with his school bag. 2: dark clouds come and it rains; Jun holds his bag over his head and is sad. 3: his friend Mei comes and shares her umbrella; they smile. 4: they arrive at school, the sun comes out and there is a rainbow over the school; they wave, and Mei holds her closed umbrella.

**How.** Open the booklet at page 2. Point to the boy in picture 1: "This is Jun." Point to the girl in picture 3: "This is Mei." Then give the prompts in order, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Wait about 5 seconds after each one; if there is no answer, go on. You may repeat a prompt once. Do not name things for the child or finish their sentences. Record what the child says on the grading sheet, as close to their words as you can.

| Step | Say | Listen for |
|---|---|---|
| 1 Open | "Look at the pictures. What can you see?" | Any naming: boy, girl, rain, umbrella, school, sun, rainbow, cloud, bag, tree |
| 2 Naming | Point to each and ask "What's this?": the umbrella (3), the rain (2), the school (4), the rainbow (4) | umbrella, rain, school, rainbow. Count how many the child names in English (out of 4) and record it |
| 3 Action | Point to picture 1. "What is Jun doing?" | walking to school, going to school, waving |
| 4 Feeling | Point to picture 2. "What happened here? How does Jun feel?" | it is raining, it started to rain; sad, wet, cold |
| 5 Action | Point to picture 3. "What does Mei do?" | shares her umbrella, holds the umbrella over Jun, helps him |
| 6 Explaining | "Why is Jun happy now?" | because he is not getting wet; because Mei helped him |
| 7 Telling | Point to picture 1. "Tell me the story. Start here." | the four pictures in order, joined with first, then, next, after that; some past tense (walked, rained) |
| 8 Predicting | "What do you think Jun will do tomorrow?" | take his umbrella; say thank you to Mei; share with Mei; check the weather |
| 9 Personal | "What do you do when it rains?" | talks about their own life |

### Speaking band at age 6 (examples from this story)

| Band | What it sounds like at age 6 | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **A** New to English | Silent, nods or points; perhaps one or two English words; may speak in Chinese | points to the umbrella; "雨伞"; "rain" |
| **B** Early acquisition | Names several things in English; single words and short phrases; little description | "umbrella", "rain", "boy sad", "school" |
| **C** Developing competence | Simple sentences, often in the present tense and with errors; can describe each picture but does not join them | "He go to school." "It is rain." "She give umbrella." |
| **D** Competent | Tells the story in order with joined sentences; explains with "because"; some past tense; errors do not get in the way | "First Jun walk to school. Then it rained and he was sad because he don't have umbrella. Mei share her umbrella." |
| **E** Fluent | Tells the story as a fluent English-speaking 6 year old does: past tense, sequence words, feelings and reasons, ideas of their own | "Jun was walking to school when it started to rain. He got all wet. Then Mei shared her umbrella with him, so they stayed dry. Tomorrow he will bring his own umbrella." |

Give the speaking band from the picture talk on the grading sheet. The final speaking band is the best fit of the picture talk and the interview (Section 5), and is given on the Interview sheet.

### What to look for

- A strong response tells the four pictures as one story, uses sequence words and the past tense, and gives reasons. A weak one names objects picture by picture.
- Do not count against the child: missing -s and -ed, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed up, accent features (l and r, light final consonants). They are normal for learners.
- A child who cannot tell the story in English but, as the parent describes, talks well in Chinese has an English barrier only. A child who says very little in either language may need a speech and language check: see the Interviewer guide and the Interview sheet.

## 3.2 Listening: follow instructions (about 5 minutes with the recording, 1:1 or pair, page 3)

**Recording.** A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y02/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

**Set up.** Open the booklet at page 3 (the farm). Put the four crayons on the table: red, blue, yellow and green. Do not name the colours. Every item leaves a mark on the page, so you can check the marks afterwards; item 9 also needs you to watch the order.

**Say:** "Let's play a listening game. Look at this picture. Listen carefully and do what I say. You will draw and colour on the picture. Ready?" Practice, not scored: "Put your finger on the picture." (Smile.) "Good!"

### Rules

- Say each instruction **once**, slowly and clearly, with a pause after each phrase (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Look at the child, not at the picture. Do not point, nod or gesture.
- If the child asks, or clearly did not hear, you may say it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. A correct response after one repeat still scores.
- With the recording, if the child asks, or clearly did not hear, pause, go back to the start of the item (the start times are in the read-me) and play it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. Pause the recording while a child is still working on an item.
- A small mark of the right colour on the right thing is enough. Say "Just a little bit of colour is fine" if the child starts colouring carefully. Drawings only need to be recognisable and in the right place.
- **Score 1** only when every part is right, and in the right order where the instruction says "then" or "before". Otherwise 0. No half marks.
- Stop after three 0s in a row.

| No. | Say | Type | Correct response |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | "Draw a circle round the tractor." | one step | a circle round the tractor |
| 2 | "Colour the sun yellow." | one step | yellow on the sun |
| 3 | "Put a cross on the hen on the fence." | position: on | a cross on the hen sitting on the fence, not the hen on the ground |
| 4 | "Draw a circle round the sheep behind the fence." | position: behind | a circle round the sheep on the right, behind the fence rails; not the sheep in front of the fence |
| 5 | "Draw a flower between the two trees." | position: between | a flower drawn in the space between the big tree and the small tree |
| 6 | "Colour the barn door red and colour the duck yellow." | two steps | red on the barn door and yellow on the duck (either order) |
| 7 | "Draw a circle round the small pig, then put a cross on the cow." | two steps | a circle round the small pig (not the big pig) and a cross on the cow |
| 8 | "Draw a line from the dog to the barn, then draw an apple on the small tree." | two steps | a line joining the dog and the barn (any route), and an apple on the small tree (not the big tree) |
| 9 | "Before you colour the big pig, draw a fish in the pond." | sequence: before | draws a fish in the pond **first**, then colours the big pig (any colour) |
| 10 | "If the dog is in the pond, colour the dog. If the dog is not in the pond, colour the pond blue." | condition: if | colours the pond blue and does not colour the dog (the dog is on the grass next to the pond) |

Total: 10 marks (1 for each item).

### Band guide (Year 2)

| Score | 0 to 2 | 3 to 4 | 5 to 6 | 7 to 8 | 9 to 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Listening band | A | B | C | D | E |

**What to look for**

- Items 1 and 2 need everyday words; 3 to 5 need the position words on, behind and between; 6 to 8 need the child to hold two instructions and words such as small, big, barn and pond; 9 and 10 need grammar ("before", "if … not").
- Right object, wrong colour: score 0, but note it. Colour words may be the only gap.
- A child who does only the first part of each two-step item is probably holding too much new English at once. A child who copies the other child (in a pair) should be seated further away; note it.

## 3.3 Reading: Early Reading Screen and Graded Sentence Reading Screen (12 minutes, 1:1)

Use the Early Reading Screen (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards` and the record sheets in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`) starting at Section 1 of the phonics words, words 1 to 10 (Year 2 start point in the guide, Section 2). If words 1 to 10 are easy (9 or 10 right, most read without sounding out), skip the letter sounds; if not, finish Section 1 and then do the letter sounds. Then use the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, with the rules in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and the score grid on the Reading front sheet) starting at Level 1.

The full scripts and rules for the Early Reading Screen are in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`. Follow the scripts, scoring and stopping rules in that guide and in the Sentence Reading Guide; these instructions have no reading tasks of their own. All answers are in English, including the answers to the questions about what the child has just read. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 of the sentence screen secure and often Level 2. Stop kindly and praise the child's effort. Record the reading results on the **Reading front sheet** (the Early Reading Screen summary and the sentence reading results) and give it to the interviewer (Sections 5 and 6). Then take the movement break.

## 3.4 Writing (6 minutes, 1:1 or pair, pages 11 and 12; given after maths)

Give the child a pencil. Do not spell any word, sound out, or write for the child.

**Part 1: a dictated sentence (page 11).** Point to the lines under "1". Say: "I will say a sentence. Listen to all of it first." Say the sentence slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2):

> "At the zoo I saw a baby panda."

Say: "Now write it here." Say the sentence again. Then say it in three parts, waiting while the child writes each part: "At the zoo … I saw … a baby panda." You may repeat a part once if the child asks. Then say: "Now check it."

**Part 2: the picture story (page 12).** Point to the story. Say: "This is the story about Jun and Mei. Write what happened. Write 2, 3 or 4 sentences." If the child is stuck, say once: "What happened first?" Do not give words or sentences. If the child asks how to write the names, write "Jun" and "Mei" on a slip of paper: the names are not part of the spelling score. When the child finishes, say "Can you read it to me?" and write down what they say on the grading sheet.

**Dictated sentence: what to record**

On the grading sheet, record for each of the eight words (At, the, zoo, I, saw, a, baby, panda) whether it is correct or shows all the sounds ("zu", "sor", "babee", "pander"), and the number of words correct out of 8. Also record whether the child used a capital A at the start, a capital I, spaces between words and a full stop, and wrote all eight words in the right order.

The content words (zoo, saw, baby, panda) are not on the reading cards, so the child has not just seen them written.

**Writing checklist (the story)**

Tick the checklist on the grading sheet: content, sentences, spelling and punctuation, and handwriting.

### Four criteria

Score each 0 to 4 for the whole writing task (1 and 3 lie between the descriptions). Total: 16 marks.

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Content and organisation | Nothing written, or not about the story | One or two ideas from the story, not yet in order ("rain. umbrella.") | Three or four pictures told in order, with a feeling or reason ("Jun was sad because he got wet.") |
| Vocabulary | No English words | Simple nouns and verbs (rain, school, go) | Words chosen for the story: umbrella, shared, wet, rainbow, friend |
| Grammar and sentences | No phrase or sentence | Short sentences or phrases, mostly present tense, with words missing ("He go school.") | Simple sentences that are mostly correct, some in the past tense, joined with and, then or because |
| Spelling and punctuation (both parts) | Random letters, or letters not linked to sounds | About half of the dictated words correct; other words show most sounds; little punctuation | 6 or more of the 8 dictated words correct; other words plausible; capital letters and full stops used most of the time |

### Writing band (best fit with the descriptors; the totals are only a guide)

| Band | Writing at age 6 | Typical total |
|---|---|---|
| **A** | Copies, writes their name or a few letters; may write in Chinese; dictated sentence not attempted or random letters | 0 to 3 |
| **B** | A few dictated words correct or plausible; one word, label or phrase about the story | 4 to 7 |
| **C** | About half the dictated sentence correct; one or two short sentences about the story that can be read with help | 8 to 10 |
| **D** | Most of the dictated sentence correct; two or three sentences that another adult can read, mostly in order | 11 to 13 |
| **E** | Comparable to a fluent English-speaking 6 year old (below) | 14 to 16 |

**What band E looks like at age 6.** The child writes the dictated sentence with nearly all the words correct ("panda" or "baby" may be a small slip), with a capital A at the start, a capital I and a full stop. They write three or four sentences that tell the story in order, using the past tense most of the time (walked, rained, shared), joining ideas with "and", "then" or "because", with spaces between words, and capital letters and full stops in most places. Longer words are spelt plausibly ("umbrela", "rainbo"). This matches the end of Year 1 expectations for a fluent English speaker.

### Spelling from children who speak Chinese

- Pinyin letter values may appear ("zu" for zoo, "sao" or "so" for saw, "pan da" written as two syllables). Count them as "all sounds shown" and note them on the grading sheet.
- Missing -ed ("Jun walk"), missing "a" and "the", and "he" for "she" are features of a learner's English: judge them under grammar, not as spelling.
- Writing in English may not have been taught in a Chinese kindergarten. A child who writes only pinyin or characters may still be a capable writer in Chinese: note it.

### What to look for

- Strong: holds the whole dictated sentence in mind, spells the common words correctly, tells the story in order with feelings and reasons.
- English barrier: forms letters well and copies the names, but cannot find the English words to tell the story; often writes a list of nouns.
- Note handwriting separately: fine motor control is not English.

## 4. Maths (15 minutes, 1:1 or pair, student booklet pages 4 to 10)

**Content:** Year 1 of the UK National Curriculum, with a few easier items first. **Section A: Number problems** (items 1 to 10, 10 marks). **Section B: Word problems and pictures** (items 11 to 20, 10 marks, including 5 word problems:

items 12, 14, 15, 16 and 18). Total 20 marks.

**How**

- Give the child a pencil and a rubber; put the pot of 20 counters on the table. Say: "Now let's do some maths. I will read every question to you. Write your answer in the box. You can use the counters."
- Show the example at the top of page 4: "Look. 2 plus 1 is 3. The 3 is in the box. Sometimes you put a tick in a box, like this."
- **Read every question aloud** with the words in the tables below, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Then you may repeat it in English as often as needed and point to the picture. A Chinese-speaking colleague may say it once in Chinese (mark **L**).
- Accept a spoken answer if the child cannot write it: write what they said beside the box and score it. Reversed digits (a backwards 2 or 7) are fine if the number is clear.
- After the session, write 1 or 0 in the mark box on each page, with NT or L beside it (list the NT and L items on the grading sheet).
- Stop as in Section 2: three 0s in a row in Section A, go to Section B; three in a row in Section B, stop.

### Section A: Number problems

| No. | Say | Answer, and what else is acceptable | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | "Number 1. Five plus three. Write the answer in the box." | **8** | |
| 2 | "Number 2. Nine take away four. Write the answer in the box." | **5** | You may also say "nine minus four". |
| 3 | "Number 3. Look at the numbers. Two numbers are missing. Write the missing numbers in the empty boxes." | **40** and **42**. 1 mark for both. | 40 for the middle box shows counting across a ten. |
| 4 | "Number 4. What is one more than forty-nine? Write it in the box." Then: "What is one less than seventy? Write it in the box." | **50** and **69**. 1 mark for both. | 410 or 491 for "one more than 49" shows the child joins digits rather than counts. |
| 5 | "Number 5. Six plus what makes ten? Write the missing number in the box." | **4** | |
| 6 | "Number 6. Count in twos: two, four, six. What comes next? Write it in the box." Then: "Count in fives: five, ten, fifteen. What comes next?" Then: "Count in tens: ten, twenty, thirty. What comes next?" | **8, 20, 40**. 1 mark for all three. | |
| 7 | "Number 7. Eight plus six. Write the answer in the box." | **14** | Crossing ten may not have been taught. |
| 8 | "Number 8. Fifteen take away seven. Write the answer in the box." | **8** | Crossing ten may not have been taught. |
| 9 | "Number 9. Thirteen plus what makes twenty? Write the missing number in the box." | **7** | Number bonds to 20 may not have been taught. |
| 10 | Point to each part as you read. "Number 10. Seven is the same as what number take away nine? Write the missing number in the box." | **16** | The equals sign at the start may not have been taught; 2 (from 9 take away 7) is the common wrong answer. |

### Section B: Word problems and pictures (WP = word problem)

| No. | Say | Answer, and what else is acceptable | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | "Number 11. Look at the pencil. How long is the pencil? Count the cubes. Write the number in the box." Then point to the balance: "Look at the balance. Draw a circle around the heavier one." | **7** cubes, and a circle round the **book**. 1 mark for both. | The book side is down. A circle round the apple shows the child does not yet read a balance. |

| No. | Say | Answer, and what else is acceptable | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 12 WP | "Number 12. Li Na has 8 stickers. Her friend gives her 5 more. How many stickers does Li Na have now? You can draw in the big box. Write the answer in the small box." | **13** | Compare with item 7: 8 plus 6. |
| 13 | "Number 13. Put a tick under the cube." (wait) "Put a tick under the cylinder." | Ticks under the **cube** and the **cylinder**, and no other shape. 1 mark. | A tick under the square instead of the cube is the common slip. English names of 3D shapes may not have been taught. |
| 14 WP | "Number 14. There are 3 rows of cakes. There are 5 cakes in each row. How many cakes are there? Write the answer in the box." | **15** | Counting in ones scores. Counting in fives is a sign of a stronger start. Arrays may not have been taught. |
| 15 WP | "Number 15. Grandma has 12 mooncakes. She puts them on 3 plates. Each plate has the same number. How many mooncakes are on each plate? You can draw on the plates. Write the answer in the box." | **4** | Sharing (平均分) may not have been taught. |
| 16 WP | "Number 16. Today is Friday. What day is tomorrow? Write it on the empty page, or tell me." | **Saturday**, written or said. Any plausible spelling ("Saterday", "Satday"). An answer in Chinese scores 0. | English day names may not have been taught. |
| 17 | Point to the big clock. "Number 17. What time does this clock show? Write the time shown in the box." Then point to the three small clocks: "Put a tick under the clock that shows half past 9." | **4 o'clock** (also "4", "4:00", "four o'clock"; 4点 said in Chinese, L), and a tick under the **third clock**. 1 mark for both. | Clocks may not have been taught. The first clock (9 o'clock) is chosen by a child who looks only for the 9; the second (half past 3) by a child who looks only at the long hand. |
| 18 WP | "Number 18. Tom has 10 balloons. He gives half of them to his sister. How many balloons does he give to his sister? You can draw circles round the balloons. Write the answer in the box." | **5** | Half of an amount may not have been taught. |
| 19 | "Number 19. Look at the three shapes. Which shape is one quarter grey? Put a tick under it." | A tick under the **square** (the third shape). | The middle shape has four parts that are not equal (its grey part is more than a quarter), so it does not show quarters: a tick under it shows the child counts the parts but does not check they are equal. Quarters may not have been taught. |
| 20 | "Number 20. Look at the arrow. It points to the tree. The arrow makes a half turn. Draw a circle around the picture it will point to." (wait) "Now start at the tree again. The arrow makes a quarter turn to the right. Put a cross on the picture it will point to." Do not turn your hand or the booklet. | A circle around the **car** (a tick on the car also scores), and a cross on the **house**. 1 mark for both. | Half and quarter turns may not have been taught. A cross on the flower shows left and right mixed up. |

### Band guide (provisional; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates)

| Total | 0 to 7 | 8 to 11 | 12 to 16 | 17 to 20 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Band | 1 Well below expected | 2 Working towards | 3 Expected | 4 Greater depth |

**Number problems and word problems.** The word problems use the same number skills as Section A: item 12 matches item 7, and items 14, 15 and 18 use counting, sharing and halving with a picture. A child who does well on the number problems but poorly on the word problems may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**: check by reading the word problem aloud again, pointing to the picture, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, having it said once in Chinese (mark L). Record the result on the grading sheet.

**Likely not yet taught**

A child who has finished the top year of kindergarten (大班) has not usually started the Grade 1 textbook, and kindergartens are asked not to teach primary school content (去小学化), although many children have done extra classes. Ask the parent.

| Item | May not have been taught |
|---|---|
| 7, 8, 9 | Adding and subtracting across ten, and number bonds to 20 (Grade 1 in the PEP textbook) |
| 10 | Missing numbers with the equals sign at the start |
| 6 | "Count in twos, fives and tens" in English (counting itself is usually strong) |
| 13 | The English names of 3D shapes (3D shapes are met in Grade 1) |
| 14, 15 | Multiplication with arrays and sharing equally (Grade 2) |
| 16 | English day names (Chinese numbers the days: 星期一 to 星期六, then 星期日) |
| 17 | O'clock and half past (Grade 1) |
| 18, 19 | Halves and quarters (fractions start in Grade 3) |
| 20 | Half and quarter turns (left and right are usually known) |

**What to look for**

- Strong children answer Section A quickly and in their heads, and use the pictures in Section B only to check. Counting in fives for item 14, or halving by knowing that 5 and 5 make 10 for item 18, shows strong number sense.
- An English barrier looks like this: the child is quick on Section A, lost on the word problems, then answers easily once you point to the picture or a colleague says it in Chinese. A maths difficulty looks like this: the child cannot do it even when the meaning is clear.
- Children from Chinese schools often calculate fast but have not met UK pictures such as arrays, quarter diagrams and turns: mark NT where the parent or child confirms it, and say whether the child would probably cope once taught.

## 5. Play-based interview and goodbye (6 minutes, 1:1, page 13)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2` and the record is the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`). Sit at the low table, open the student booklet at page 13 (Draw) and offer the crayons: the interview starts with a drawing ("Can you draw you, doing something you love?"). Play alongside, talk about the drawing and follow the child's lead. Give the speaking band on the Interview sheet, combining the interview with the picture talk (recorded on the grading sheet). The observation boxes on the Interview sheet cover the whole visit, so fill them in now.

**Goodbye.** Say: "Thank you, [name]! You worked really hard today. I liked [something specific, such as your story or your drawing]. Let's go and find Mum (or Dad)." Do not give any results to the family on the day.

## 6. Recording the results

1. Mark the student booklet the same day (every maths question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet (the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen, guide section 6.7).
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student booklet with them (or shred it under the school's policy).